

WFLOW-99: Best Practice Summary

Series: WFLOW — Workflows and Alert Notifications | **Notebook:** 99 | **Created:** March 2026 | **Last Updated:** 07/21/2026

Overview

This notebook consolidates every actionable best practice from the WFLOW series (notebooks 01-09) into definitive tables organized by category. Each best practice includes the exact setting or value to use, a priority rating, and the source notebook.

Table of Contents

1. [Workflow Design & Architecture](#)
 2. [Triggers](#)
 3. [Connections & Credentials](#)
 4. [Notification Channels](#)
 5. [Message Formatting & Templates](#)
 6. [Routing & Escalation](#)
 7. [Incident Management Integration](#)
 8. [Auto-Remediation](#)
 9. [JavaScript & HTTP Actions](#)
 10. [Security](#)
 11. [Access Control](#)
 12. [Observability & Monitoring](#)
 13. [Operations & Change Management](#)
-

1. Workflow Design & Architecture

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
1	Use Workflows for all new automation	Workflows (not legacy alerting profiles)	Critical	WFLOW-01
2	Keep workflows small and focused	One trigger → one outcome; avoid sprawling multi-stage workflows (community practice — explicit max-execution-time is not published in current docs; verify against your tenant under load)	Recommended	WFLOW-01
3	Keep task count modest	~20 tasks per workflow as a soft ceiling (community practice — split larger flows into sub-workflows). Hard max not published in current docs.	Recommended	WFLOW-01
4	Set explicit task timeouts	Default is 60 minutes; max 7 days. Configure <code>timeout: <seconds></code> per task. Distinct from the 120s Dynatrace runtime budget that caps each action (DQL/JS) inside the task.	Critical	WFLOW-01, WFLOW-08
5	Avoid uncontrolled fan-out	Throttle high-cardinality triggers (community practice — explicit concurrent-execution cap is not published in current docs; verify against your tenant).	Recommended	WFLOW-01
6	Start with simple notifications	Basic notifications first, then layer in complexity	Recommended	WFLOW-09
7	Run notification tasks in parallel	Default parallel execution for independent tasks (Slack + Teams + Email simultaneously)	Recommended	WFLOW-03
8	Use sequential execution with <code>dependsOn</code>	Chain tasks that require previous task output	Recommended	WFLOW-04

2. Triggers

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
1	Use Detected Problem trigger for incident alerts	<code>type: davis-problem</code>	Critical	WFLOW-02
2	Use Detected Event trigger for proactive metric thresholds	<code>type: davis-event</code> with DQL query and <code>evaluationFrequency: "5m"</code>	Critical	WFLOW-02
3	Use Schedule trigger for reports and health checks	<code>type: schedule</code> with cron expression and explicit <code>timezone</code>	Critical	WFLOW-02
4	Use On-Demand trigger for testing	<code>type: on-demand</code> before deploying any production workflow	Critical	WFLOW-02
5	Scope Detected Problem triggers with entity tags	<code>entityTagsMatch: all</code> with <code>entityTags: [{key: env, value: prod}]</code>	Critical	WFLOW-02
6	Filter by problem categories	Set <code>categories: [AVAILABILITY, PERFORMANCE]</code> to reduce noise	Recommended	WFLOW-02
7	Handle all problem lifecycle events	Trigger on OPEN, UPDATED, and CLOSED statuses in a single workflow	Recommended	WFLOW-05
8	Offset scheduled workflows from minute :00	Use <code>:05</code> , <code>:15</code> , <code>:30</code> instead of <code>:00</code> to spread load	Recommended	WFLOW-02
9	Always set timezone on schedule triggers	<code>timezone: "America/New_York"</code> (explicit, never rely on default)	Recommended	WFLOW-02
10	Use Event trigger for business process automation	<code>type: event</code> with <code>filterQuery</code> for bizevent-driven workflows	Optional	WFLOW-02

3. Connections & Credentials

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
1	Use descriptive connection names	Pattern: <service>-<environment>-<purpose> (e.g., slack-prod-oncall)	Critical	WFLOW-03
2	Separate connections per environment	Distinct connections for prod vs staging vs dev	Critical	WFLOW-03
3	Apply least-privilege scopes	Minimum OAuth scopes required (e.g., Slack: chat:write , chat:write.public only)	Critical	WFLOW-03
4	Rotate tokens on a schedule	Monthly rotation of API tokens and passwords	Recommended	WFLOW-09
5	Use OAuth 2.0 over Basic Auth for ServiceNow	OAuth 2.0 for production; Basic Auth only for dev/testing	Recommended	WFLOW-05
6	Create separate PagerDuty connections per service routing	pagerduty-prod-critical , pagerduty-prod-standard , pagerduty-platform	Recommended	WFLOW-05
7	Prefer Slack OAuth App over Incoming Webhook	OAuth App provides channels, DMs, reactions, threads	Recommended	WFLOW-03

4. Notification Channels

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
1	Multi-channel for Critical production problems	PagerDuty + Slack #urgent + Email simultaneously	Critical	WFLOW-03, WFLOW-04
2	Slack for High production problems	Slack #alerts + Email	Recommended	WFLOW-04

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
3	Slack-only for Medium problems	Slack #alerts (business hours only for Low)	Recommended	WFLOW-04
4	Use Power Automate connector for Teams	Microsoft is deprecating Office 365 Connectors; use newer Workflows connector	Recommended	WFLOW-03
5	Use built-in email for simple notifications	No SMTP setup required; use custom SMTP or SendGrid for high volume	Optional	WFLOW-03
6	Include severity in email subject line	<code>{{ event()['severity'] }}</code> <code>{{ event()['title'] }}</code>	Recommended	WFLOW-03

5. Message Formatting & Templates

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
1	Structure messages: Severity + Title + Key metrics + Link	Line 1: severity indicator + title; Line 2: impact; Line 3: affected entities; Line 4: action link	Critical	WFLOW-06
2	Use severity-coded visual indicators	Slack: <code>:red_circle:</code> CRITICAL, <code>:large_orange_circle:</code> HIGH, <code>:large_yellow_circle:</code> MEDIUM, <code>:large_blue_circle:</code> LOW	Critical	WFLOW-06
3	Use Slack Block Kit for rich messages	<code>blocks:</code> with <code>header</code> , <code>section</code> , <code>actions</code> , <code>context</code> types	Recommended	WFLOW-06
4	Use Teams Adaptive Cards v1.4	<code>type:</code> <code>AdaptiveCard</code> , <code>version:</code> <code>"1.4"</code> with <code>FactSet</code> , <code>TextBlock</code> , <code>Action.OpenUrl</code>	Recommended	WFLOW-06

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
5	Always include a link to the Dynatrace problem	<code><{{ event()['problem_url'] }} View in Dynatrace></code> (Slack) or <code>Action.OpenUrl</code> (Teams)	Critical	WFLOW-03
6	Use dictionary mapping for severity-to-emoji	<code>{{ {"CRITICAL": ":red_circle:", ...}.get(event()["severity"], ":white_circle:") }}</code>	Recommended	WFLOW-06
7	Limit affected entities shown to 3-5	<code>event()["affected_entity_ids"][:3]</code> with overflow indicator	Recommended	WFLOW-06
8	Use <code>.get()</code> with defaults for optional fields	<code>event().get("root_cause_entity_id", "Pending analysis")</code>	Critical	WFLOW-06
9	Truncate long strings	<code>{{ event()["title"] \ truncate(50) }}</code>	Recommended	WFLOW-06
10	Enrich notifications with DQL data	Add recent error logs via <code>queryExecutionClient.queryExecute()</code> in a JavaScript task before the notification task	Optional	WFLOW-06
11	Test templates with mock data first	On-Demand trigger + JavaScript mock event task before production deployment	Critical	WFLOW-06
12	Preview Slack templates in Block Kit Builder	https://app.slack.com/block-kit-builder before deploying	Recommended	WFLOW-06

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
13	Create a resolved-problem template	<code>:white_check_mark:</code> Problem Resolved with duration and resolution time	Recommended	WFLOW-06

6. Routing & Escalation

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
1	Route by severity	CRITICAL: PagerDuty + Slack + Email; HIGH: Slack + Email; MEDIUM: Slack; LOW: Slack business hours only	Critical	WFLOW-04
2	Route by team ownership via entity tags	Condition: <code>"team:checkout"</code> in <code>event().get("tags", [])</code> maps to <code>#checkout-alerts</code>	Critical	WFLOW-04
3	Do not route by management zone	<code>"Production"</code> in <code>event()["management_zones"]</code> is legacy. It fails silently once MZs are retired — the array empties, conditions go false, notifications stop with no error. Route on entity tags (<code>env:prod</code>) or Smartscape ownership instead	Critical	WFLOW-04
4	Implement time-based routing	Business hours (Mon-Fri 9-17): Slack channel; Off-hours Critical: PagerDuty; Off-hours non-critical: queue for morning	Critical	WFLOW-04
5	Auto-escalate unacknowledged alerts	Wait 15 min, check if still OPEN, escalate to PagerDuty if unacknowledged	Recommended	WFLOW-04
6	Multi-tier escalation	0 min: Slack; 15 min: Email team lead; 30 min: PagerDuty on-call; 60 min: PagerDuty manager	Recommended	WFLOW-04
7	Use AND logic for multi-condition tasks	<code>conditions: [is_critical, is_production]</code> requires both true	Recommended	WFLOW-04

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
8	Use JavaScript for dynamic channel selection	Parse <code>team:</code> tag to construct <code>#\${team}-alerts</code> dynamically	Optional	WFLOW-04
9	Separate environment routing	Production: immediate notification; Staging: Slack only; Dev: daily digest	Recommended	WFLOW-04

7. Incident Management Integration

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
1	Deduplicate PagerDuty incidents	<code>dedupKey: "dynatrace-{{ event()['display_id'] }}"</code>	Critical	WFLOW-05
2	Deduplicate ServiceNow incidents	<code>correlation_id: "DT-{{ event()['display_id'] }}"</code>	Critical	WFLOW-05
3	Map Dynatrace severity to PagerDuty severity	CRITICAL: <code>critical</code> ; HIGH: <code>error</code> ; MEDIUM: <code>warning</code> ; LOW: <code>info</code>	Critical	WFLOW-05
4	Map Dynatrace severity to ServiceNow impact/urgency	CRITICAL: <code>impact=1, urgency=1</code> ; HIGH: <code>impact=2, urgency=2</code> ; MEDIUM: <code>impact=2, urgency=2</code> ; LOW: <code>impact=3, urgency=3</code>	Critical	WFLOW-05
5	Auto-resolve incidents when problem closes	Trigger on <code>event()["status"] == "CLOSED"</code> , resolve PagerDuty via <code>dedupKey</code> or set ServiceNow <code>state: 6</code>	Critical	WFLOW-05
6	Include Dynatrace problem URL in incident details	<code>customDetails.problem_url</code> (PagerDuty) or <code>description</code> body (ServiceNow)	Critical	WFLOW-05
7	Store incident ID for subsequent updates	Capture <code>sys_id</code> from create response in a JavaScript task for update/resolve operations	Recommended	WFLOW-05
8	Use PagerDuty Events API v2	Integration type: Events API v2 (not v1)	Critical	WFLOW-05

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
9	Set <code>assignment_group</code> and <code>caller_id</code> in ServiceNow	<code>assignment_group: "Platform Engineering", caller_id: "dynatrace.integration"</code>	Recommended	WFLOW-05
10	Implement bi-directional sync	Scheduled workflow queries ServiceNow for open DT-correlated incidents and updates Dynatrace problem comments	Optional	WFLOW-05

8. Auto-Remediation

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
1	Rate-limit remediation attempts	Max 3 remediations per hour per entity	Critical	WFLOW-07
2	Enforce time-window guardrails	Remediation only during safe hours: weekdays 06:00-22:00	Critical	WFLOW-07
3	Implement cooldown periods	30 minutes minimum between remediation actions on the same entity	Critical	WFLOW-07
4	Capture pre-remediation state for rollback	Record current state before executing any change	Critical	WFLOW-07
5	Require human approval for production remediation	Slack approval buttons with 30-minute timeout; auto-approve for non-production only	Critical	WFLOW-07
6	Auto-remediate only well-defined scenarios	Pod crash loops: yes (restart); Disk space 90%: yes (cleanup); Database deadlocks: no (investigate); Security incidents: no (human judgment)	Critical	WFLOW-07

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
7	Follow remediation maturity model	Level 0: manual; Level 1: notification + runbook link; Level 2: semi-automated (approval); Level 3: fully automated with guardrails	Recommended	WFLOW-07
8	Map problem types to runbooks	JavaScript <code>runbookMap</code> object mapping problem title patterns to runbook IDs	Recommended	WFLOW-07
9	Include runbook links in notifications	Jinja conditional: <code>{% if "CPU" in event()["title"] %}</code> links to CPU runbook	Recommended	WFLOW-07
10	Validate after remediation	Query metrics/logs post-action to confirm resolution	Recommended	WFLOW-07
11	Start non-prod, promote to prod	Test all remediation workflows in staging before enabling in production	Critical	WFLOW-07

9. JavaScript & HTTP Actions

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
1	Always use <code>export default async function</code>	Required function signature for every JavaScript action	Critical	WFLOW-08
2	Wrap all external calls in try-catch	Return <code>{success: false, error: error.message}</code> on failure instead of throwing	Critical	WFLOW-08
3	Implement retry with exponential backoff	Max 3 retries, delay = <code>1000 * attempt</code> ms, retry only on 5xx errors	Recommended	WFLOW-08
4	Set request timeouts on external HTTP	<code>AbortController</code> with 10-second timeout on outbound <code>fetch()</code> calls. Distinct from task <code>timeout</code> (whole-task budget) and 120s runtime budget (per-action). See WFLOW-08 §8.	Critical	WFLOW-08

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
5	Set DQL query timeouts	<code>requestTimeoutMilliseconds: 30000</code> on all <code>queryExecute()</code> calls. This caps the SDK→engine HTTP call only; the engine's own 120s runtime budget still applies. See WFLOW-08 §8.	Critical	WFLOW-08
6	Limit DQL query scope	<code>from: now() - 1h , select only needed fields , limit 100</code>	Critical	WFLOW-08
7	Use <code>Promise.all()</code> for parallel entity lookups	Execute all independent API calls concurrently	Recommended	WFLOW-08
8	Always use HTTPS for external calls	Never use <code>http://</code> in HTTP request URLs	Critical	WFLOW-09
9	Access secrets via <code>env</code> object only	<code>env.API_TOKEN</code> (never hardcode, never log secrets via <code>console.log</code>)	Critical	WFLOW-08, WFLOW-09
10	Add problem comments after remediation	Use <code>problemsClient.createComment()</code> to record automated actions	Recommended	WFLOW-08
11	Validate secret existence before use	<code>if (!apiToken) throw new Error('Missing required secret: ...')</code>	Recommended	WFLOW-09

10. Security

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
1	Never hardcode secrets in workflows	Use <code>{{ env.SECRET_NAME }}</code> in YAML or <code>env.SECRET_NAME</code> in JavaScript	Critical	WFLOW-09

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
2	Sanitize all dynamic inputs	Remove <code>''\</code> characters, limit string length to 200 chars before using in queries	Critical	WFLOW-09
3	Never log secrets	Do not use <code>console.log(env.API_TOKEN)</code> or return secrets in task output	Critical	WFLOW-09
4	Use secret naming convention	Pattern: <code><SERVICE>_API_TOKEN</code> , <code><SERVICE>_WEBHOOK_URL</code> , <code><SERVICE>_<ENV>_CRED</code>	Recommended	WFLOW-09
5	Rotate secrets monthly	Create new secret, update workflow, test, remove old secret	Recommended	WFLOW-09
6	Fail secure on errors	Default to safe state (no action) when errors occur, never expose error details externally	Critical	WFLOW-09

11. Access Control

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
1	Grant minimum permissions per role	Viewers: <code>automation:workflows:read</code> ; App teams: <code>read + write + run</code> (own workflows); SRE: <code>read + write + run</code> (all); Admins: <code>admin</code>	Critical	WFLOW-09
2	Restrict workflow write to owners	IAM policy: <code>ALLOW automation:workflows:write WHERE workflow.owner == "\${user.email}"</code>	Recommended	WFLOW-09
3	Separate connection write access	<code>automation:connections:write</code> only for workflow admins and SRE	Critical	WFLOW-09
4	Tag workflows with ownership metadata	<code>metadata.owner: sre-team@company.com</code> , <code>metadata.team: platform</code> , <code>metadata.classification: production</code>	Recommended	WFLOW-09

12. Observability & Monitoring

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
1	Alert on workflow success rate	Threshold: < 95% success rate over 7 days	Critical	WFLOW-09
2	Alert on average execution duration	Threshold: > 5 minutes average	Recommended	WFLOW-09
3	Alert on failure spike	Threshold: > 5 failures per hour	Critical	WFLOW-09
4	Build a workflow health dashboard	Queries: overall health, per-workflow success rates, execution trend, recent failures, task-level performance	Critical	WFLOW-09
5	Create a workflow-monitoring workflow	Scheduled every 15-60 min; query for workflows with 3+ failures/hour; alert to <code>#workflow-alerts</code>	Recommended	WFLOW-09
6	Monitor notification task success rates	Query <code>automation.task.execution</code> filtered by <code>slack</code> , <code>msteams</code> , <code>email</code> , <code>pagerduty</code> task types	Recommended	WFLOW-03
7	Track remediation success rates	Query <code>automation.workflow.execution</code> filtered by <code>remediation</code> or <code>auto-heal</code> workflow names	Recommended	WFLOW-07
8	Monitor skipped tasks	Query <code>task.status == "SKIPPED"</code> to validate routing conditions are working as designed	Optional	WFLOW-04

13. Operations & Change Management

#	Best Practice	Recommended Setting/Value	Priority	Source
1	Name workflows consistently	Pattern: <team>--<function>--<environment> (e.g., sre-problem-notifications-prod)	Critical	WFLOW-09
2	Export workflows as JSON for version control	GET /platform/automation/v1/workflows/<id> saved to Git	Recommended	WFLOW-09
3	Test changes on cloned workflow first	Clone, modify, test with On-Demand trigger, review results, promote	Critical	WFLOW-09
4	Rollback procedure	Disable failing workflow (toggle off), import previous JSON, enable restored version, verify	Critical	WFLOW-09
5	Daily: check execution dashboard	Review success rates and investigate failures	Recommended	WFLOW-09
6	Weekly: verify external connections	Test all Slack, Teams, PagerDuty, ServiceNow connections	Recommended	WFLOW-09
7	Monthly: rotate secrets	Update API tokens, passwords, webhook URLs	Recommended	WFLOW-09
8	Query execution history with DQL	fetch events, from: now() - 24h \\ filter event.type == "automation.workflow.execution"	Recommended	WFLOW-01

Summary

This notebook contains **91 best practices** across 13 categories extracted from the complete WFLOW series.

Priority distribution:

Priority	Count	Meaning
Critical	47	Must implement for production readiness
Recommended	38	Strongly advised for operational maturity
Optional	6	Beneficial for advanced use cases

Implementation order:

1. Connections and credentials (WFLOW-03)
2. Basic problem notification workflow with severity routing (WFLOW-03, WFLOW-04)
3. Incident management integration with deduplication (WFLOW-05)
4. Custom templates with severity indicators and links (WFLOW-06)
5. Workflow health monitoring dashboard (WFLOW-09)
6. Auto-remediation with guardrails (WFLOW-07)

References

- [Workflows umbrella \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [Workflow triggers \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [Workflow actions \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [Notification actions umbrella \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [HTTP request action \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [Run JavaScript action \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [Workflow reference / Jinja expressions \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [Davis Problems app \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [Alerting and notifications umbrella \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [Upgrade guide — Alert notification \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [Dynatrace Developer Portal \(Dynatrace\)](#)
-

This notebook was AI-generated from community-submitted and publicly available sources. This notebook series is not officially supported by Dynatrace. Always verify information against official Dynatrace documentation.